



Priorities

- No more reports. He has enough recommendations to choose from, both from Arjun Singh's bugbear, the National Knowledge Commission, and the report of the Yashpal Committee.
- Needs to ensure access, equity and quality in primary and secondary school education.
- Has to create a skills development mission.
- Needs to overhaul higher education, ensuring expansion, excellence and inclusion, and regulation of professional education.

Is he the one? He speaks the language of Left-wing academics and has the acumen required to get complex legislation such as the Right to Education off the ground. He is a man of integrity, so expectations are high that he will clean up the corruption-ridden ministry and review inept higher education regulatory authorities such as the UGC and AICTE.

Personal Quirk

Cannot resist a good debating opportunity.

▼ 70%

Priorities

- Help IT & services retain a tax holiday beyond 2010 and revive the sector.
- Propel Rs 1,50,000 crore of investments to make India a hardware hub.
- Drive initiatives to make e-governance a reality down to the taluka level.
- Ensure 3G auction and launch by January 2010 to make mobile broadband available in rural areas.

Is he the one? Few expected him to get a grip on the sector, but he delivered on affordability—bringing down STD rates to 50 paise—and teledensity. His performance, though, was clouded by allegations of corruption and neglect of the IT sector. The focus this time is on making India a hardware hub and e-governance for the masses.

Style Statement

Starched white *veshti* and shirt in summer, safari suits with designer shawls in winter.

▼ 60%

KAMAL NATH

Road Transport and Highways

One For The Road | Credited with initiating the country's first comprehensive foreign trade policy during his term as commerce minister, Kamal Nath's policies helped double India's foreign trade within three years. He also won kudos for the effective steps made in the field of Intellectual Property and Industrial Design. The Congress long-timer was first elected to the seventh Lok Sabha in 1980.

Priorities

- Should turn around the National Highways Development Programme, which is now a picture of slippage in project implementation.
- Should accelerate efforts to complete 23,476 km of the highway construction in time.
- Priority should be given to tackle the problems faced by developers like shortage of credit and undue interference from the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI).
- Land acquisition-related issues should be addressed.

Is he the one? While allocating Nath the key infrastructure portfolio, Congress chief Sonia Gandhi told him: "I will give you something challenging". Nath, of course, has a tough challenge ahead. Chances are that this being a ministry where success is measurable Nath will break new grounds and go for it. Expect him to set the roads sector on the expressway.

Personal Quirk

An unlikely numerologist, yet he considers his Doon School roll number 366 lucky.

▼ 70%

